Ali] Zardari after Benazir [Bhutto]'s death, and elected him. People don't know how to vote.

(Focus Group, Private University[62])

Others say that the army is necessary because of the deteriorating security situation: '*It brings up the argument of security versus freedom. How much of our freedom are we willing to give up for that security?*' (Focus Group, Private University[63]). And given the levels of violence, few can argue with that logic. The army has been fighting terrorism at all fronts in Pakistan, from the Zarb-e-Azb operation in Waziristan, to targeting terrorist outfits within urban centres. The support for the army as the only functioning institution is therefore quite strong.

Since the participants in this study had witnessed General Pervez Musharraf's rule, there were participants who expressed outright support for the general. Students, especially those in private universities, gave Musharraf's rule as an example of 'good governance': '*Local government under Musharraf when we had a local nazim [it's a local organiser/district representative – part of the administrative system] worked. … It is interesting how under a military dictatorship we had nazims; streets and roads were changed but no nazims under a democracy*' (Focus Group, Private University[64]); '*Musharraf represented us. The dollar was 60 rupees then, petrol was 30–35 rupees/litre. In his time Pakistan was in the limelight, Musharraf is the only brave leader that Pakistan has ever had. With the line of control, and Kargil, he was the (COAS[65]), and on his orders did the army move into the Kargil territory … Musharraf [was the] only leader after Bhutto bold enough to take steps needed to show other countries*' (Focus Group, Private University[66]). '*Musharraf is the lesser evil*'; '*Things were so much better when he was in government. He took action against the Taliban*'; '*Martial law is more efficient*' (Focus Group, Private University[67]).

However, many of those who disagree with army rule also point to the problems with the democratic system they have been living under. Interestingly none of the respondents came out clearly in favour of democracy, rather focusing on the issues that the democratic system in Pakistan faced: '*If democracy changed anything, it'd be illegal. For me, democracy is an illusion, a capitalist agenda which could never work in a country like Pakistan*' (Focus Group, Private University[68]); '*No … but military dictatorship brings in a different set of problems, while democracy brings in another set of problems*' (Focus Group, Private University[69]); '*We are so confused and divided which is why democracy does not work. Look at our group, confused about what it is, whether the army should come in or not*' (Focus Group, Private University[70]). Others argue that for democracy to take